

Preface:**Submission Folder Contents:****SUBMISSION:**

- | | |
|--------------------|---|
| COMMENTARY.pdf | - This document |
| Frieren_stereo.mp4 | - Mix of Frieren (stereo only) |
| Suzume_5.1.mp4 | - Suzume mixed in 5.1 - preferred marking material |
| Suzume_stereo.mp4 | - Suzume mixed in stereo, for stereo-only capable devices |

TIMECODED VIDEO FILES:

- | | |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Frieren_stereo_TIMECODE.mp4 | - Frieren stereo mix with timecode |
| Suzume_5.1_TIMECODE.mp4 | - Suzume 5.1 mix with timecode |
| Suzume_stereo_TIMECODE.mp4 | - Suzume stereo mix with timecode |

PROJECT FILES:**Cubase Projects:**

- | | |
|------------------------|--|
| Frieren Soundtrack.zip | - Project files from the writing stage of each project (includes MIDI data, written in Cubase 14.0.10) |
| Frieren ED.zip | |
| Suzume.zip | |

FL Studio Project and Mix:

- | | |
|----------------|--|
| Frieren OP.zip | - Project files from the writing, mixing, and mastering stage. (includes MIDI data, written in FL Studio 2024.1.2) |
|----------------|--|

Pro Tools Mix:

- | | |
|------------------------|--|
| Frieren ED.zip | - Project files from the mixing stage of each project. (Pro Tools 2024.6.0 versions of projects) |
| Frieren Soundtrack.zip | |
| Suzume 5.1.zip | |
| Suzume stereo.zip | |

ORIGINAL MATERIAL:**Film with music removed:**

- | | |
|-----------------------------|---|
| NO-MUSIC-Frieren-Stereo.mp4 | - Contains video, sound effects, and dialogue, but all music has been removed |
| NO-MUSIC-Suzume-Stereo.mp4 | |
| NO-MUSIC-Suzume-5.1.mp4 | |

Original Film:

- | | |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ORIGINAL-Suzume-5.1.mp4 | - Original video and soundtrack |
| ORIGINAL-Frieren-Stereo.mp4 | |

How to view the submitted video files:

If accessing from a Mac, QuickTime Player is recommended. On Windows, please use VLC. All video files include English subtitle tracks that can be enabled.

Abbreviations used in file names:

Sousou no Frieren (Frieren), Opening Sequence (OP), Ending Sequence (ED), Suzume no Tojimari (Suzume).

Process of Composition:

Frieren Soundtrack, Frieren ED, and Suzume were sequenced in Cubase 14, then mixed and mastered in Pro Tools 2024.

Frieren OP was written, mixed and mastered in FL Studio.

Key of characters in each film:

Sousou no Frieren:¹



Suzume no Tojimari:²



Souta Munakata



Suzume Iwato

Composition Folio Commentary:

I chose to score music for film in the field of anime because my career goal is to become a full-time composer for television for Japanese media. I picked this material, as *Sousou no Frieren (Frieren)* and *Suzume no Tojimari (Suzume)* contain some of my favourite soundtracks and are works I greatly look up to. In undertaking this project, I wanted to trace the

¹ 'List of Characters', *Frieren Wiki*, 4 May 2025, accessed 9 April 2025
https://frieren.fandom.com/wiki/List_of_Characters.

² 'Suzume Characters', *Makoto Shinkai Wiki*, accessed 9 April 2025
https://makotoshinkai.fandom.com/wiki/Category:Suzume_characters.

footsteps of the composers of these works (Evan Call, Kazuma Jinnouchi & Robert Hoffman), and relive the same challenges that they faced.

Music in anime (Japanese animated television) contains three elements. The opening theme (OP), ending theme (ED) and background music (BGM). It is typical practice for one opening and ending theme to be used for all 12 episodes of a show's season and is customary to commission current popular Japanese pop (J-pop) artists to produce these. Lyrics typically loosely resemble themes and overarching messages of the anime, but this is not always a strict requirement.³ A few examples of comparable works that follow this standard are Hyouka OP: ChouCho's *Yasashisa no Riyuu*⁴, Sword Art Online OP: LiSA's *Crossing Field*⁵, Violet Evergarden ED: Minori Chihara's *Michishirube*⁶, and Attack on Titan ED: Yoko Hisaka's *Utsukushiki Zankokuna Sekai*⁷.

Extracting stems:

In order to preserve highest fidelity of both audio and video, I acquired the original films from BlueRay discs and used ffmpeg⁸ to extract the raw (PCM) audio and re-package it into WAV format (see Figure 8). Once the lossless audio was extracted, I had to separate the dialogue, music, and sound effects in order to remove the original music and write my own.

I chose Bandit V2⁹ for this purpose because it is a model trained on Divide and Remaster version 3¹⁰ a Cinematic Audio Source Separation dataset. It significantly

³ 'Original Soundtrack (OST) - Anime News Network:W', accessed 9 April 2025 <https://www.animenewsnetwork.com/encyclopedia/lexicon.php?id=74>.

⁴ *Yasashisa No Riyu*, 2024, accessed 2 March 2025 <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E22Fj5WCv2U>.

⁵ *Crossing Field*, 2021, accessed 2 March 2025 <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F9GXgPHeKfA>.

⁶ *みちしるべ (Short Size)*, 2020, accessed 2 March 2025 <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FiQ1nAurKal>.

⁷ *美しき残酷な世界*, accessed 2 March 2025 <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BbTR1i2UrqM>.

⁸ 'FFmpeg/FFmpeg', C (2011; repr., FFmpeg, 20 February 2025), accessed 20 February 2025 <https://github.com/FFmpeg/FFmpeg>.

⁹ Karn Watcharasupat, 'Kwatcharasupat/Bandit-V2', Python, (2024; repr., 25 January 2025), accessed 20 February 2025 <https://github.com/kwatcharasupat/bandit-v2>.

¹⁰ Karn N. Watcharasupat, Chih-Wei Wu, and Iroro Orife, *Remastering Divide and Remaster: A Cinematic Audio Source Separation Dataset with Multilingual Support* (arXiv, 26 August 2024), accessed 20 February 2025 doi:10.48550/arXiv.2407.07275; Karn Watcharasupat, Chih-Wei Wu, and Iroro Orife, 'Model Weights for "Remastering Divide and Remaster: A Cinematic Audio Source Separation Dataset with Multilingual

outperformed results from its predecessor Bandit, as well as popular models such as Demucus v4¹¹ and MDX-Net.¹² These two are trained on music, rather than cinematic datasets so they would not have been ideal choices. At the time of writing (March 2025), Bandit (V1) and Bandit V2 are the only publicly available models trained specifically on cinematic datasets. The results of Bandit V2 are by no means perfect, and artifacting and bleed from background noise can be heard at points (for example Frieren at 23:17). As this is currently still a new and emerging technology, further research and development is still required in this field.

Frieren Opening Sequence:

My track follows the shortened standard format of a J-pop track. Most J-pop tracks are between three and five minutes, however for an anime opening sequence, a condensed 90-second version of the track is used. My instrumentation combines iconic J-pop elements such as slap bass and short-release synthesised piano with Jazz big band orchestral instrumentation (see Figure 1). There is no standardised structure format in this medium¹³, so I opted for a basic 'Intro, Chorus, Verse, Chorus, Outro' structure. The lyrics follow the anime's theme of exploring Frieren's perception of time (see Figure 2), and I wrote, sang, and recorded these for this project. In order to sow harmonic variety, the verse (00:34) uses the $\flat vii$ chord and tritone substitutions (00:52). The unusual instrumentation, with the pairing of instruments such as shakuhachi, trumpets, celeste, violins, and bass guitar create a unique sound world. By sequencing these instruments rather than orchestrating them for live performance, it enabled me to sidestep balance issues (such as the trumpets overwhelming the shakuhachi) through gain staging, stereo panning, and using EQ to allow each instrument to occupy its own space within the frequency spectrum.

Frieren Ending Sequence:

Support", 9 July 2024, accessed 20 February 2025 <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.12701995>; Watcharasupat, Wu, and Orife, 'Remastering Divide and Remaster'.

¹¹ 'Facebookresearch/Demucs', Python (2019; repr., Meta Research, 20 February 2025), accessed 20 February 2025 <https://github.com/facebookresearch/demucs>.

¹² 'Kuielab/Mdx-Net', Python (2021; repr., IELab@ Korea University, 18 February 2025), accessed 20 February 2025 <https://github.com/kuielab/mdx-net>.

¹³ *Anime Opening Song Forms Are Predictable*, 2020, accessed 9 April 2025 <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UudxSY9rx0I>.

The visuals of the ED sequence are more reflective, soft, and abstract than the OP. In order to accommodate this, I wrote a pop-lullaby track to mirror the energy level of the picture. I constructed the lyrics (see Figures 4 & 5) and instrumentation with this in mind. I initially wanted to get a female native Japanese speaker to sing this, as I felt the sonority of a female voice would suit the atmosphere better, and a native speaker would be able to more-accurately produce the bright, open vowel sounds of Japanese. Unfortunately, despite my best efforts I was unable to find someone who could fit the criteria.

I chose to write for marimba, harp, flute, glockenspiel, mandolin, violin, viola, and cello to explore the soft, gentle timbral abilities of these instruments in combination. The violins play *con sordini*, and the celli predominantly play *pizzicato*. In contrast with the opening sequence, here the harmony here remains relatively basic. This is intentionally done not to distract the listener, while creating a warm harmonic and textural bed for the melody to sit on top of (see Figure 3).

Sousou no Frieren Soundtrack:

My primary goal was to amplify the characters' emotions and mirror the emotional outline sculpted by the narrative, voice acting, and animation.

The instrumentation (see Figure 6) is a blend of instruments reminiscent of a late-Romantic symphony orchestra, combined with Chinese and Japanese traditional instruments, and elements of electronic synthesis. My choice to blend Chinese traditional instruments into an entirely Japanese production reflects the story's setting within the film: a world which initially seems like our own but with key differing, fantastical foreign qualities.

In writing the first cue (02:24), I wanted to capture a warm and reminiscent sound. The visuals show a montage spanning many seasons, over the time Frieren, Fern and Heiter spend together. To capture a sense of 'warmth', I used a brass sample library recorded on tape, which was rich with harmonics through its tape saturation. The brass underpins the harmony, while the violins and dizi (Chinese flute-like instrument) carry the melody.

The second cue (05:07) opens with solo piano. The isolated high register, and spacious scoring reflects the internal feelings of Fern who feels empty and destitute after the death of both of her parents. In order to emphasise the intimacy, I reduced the

instrumentation to solo cello and piano. As the scene develops the piano's register expands, becoming more grounded as Heiter's encouragement for Fern not to kill herself takes root.

Melodic material is shared between cue 2 and 4 which both have the common topic of Heiter saving Fern, but now we see this scene from Heiter's perspective. Cue 4's music is more bittersweet than its counterpart, with richer orchestration and increased dissonances, showing Heiter's clear resolve, giving the audience some understanding that Heiter looked up to Himmel and attempted to be a better person because of his influence.

At cue 3 (07:01), the visual direction of books floating down is mirrored with a descending hand harp phrase that develops into a reflective montage. The slow harmonic pace and reduced instrumentation sets up for the contrasting end of cue 3 (07:42) where Fern uses the strongest magic she possibly can. This display of strength is orchestrated through tremolo strings, brass and choir swells, harp glissandi, and a gong roll. The climactic chord is intentionally left as a harmonically ambiguous chord cluster, as it is not revealed until later (10:35) whether Fern's effort resulted in a success.

Cue 5's rhythmic and instrumental shift marks the start of Fern and Frieren's Journey (11:26). Despite Frieren's flashback of past anecdotes in cue 5.2 (13:51), the narrative's shifted perspective presents this as context to the current story rather than as a story in of itself. This cue acts also as a 'travelling' theme, where the action of walking is musically depicted through the plodding repetitively alternating 'E, D' bassline.

Cue 6 (16:34) consists of two halves. Within the first half, the harmony is relatively static. The harmonic outline from 17:09 is Emaj9/C#, Emaj9/G#, Emaj7/F# Emaj7/G#, staying around the key centre of E major for as long as possible to showcase the slowness of the two character's days depicted on screen. In the second half of cue 6 (17:35), the blend of violins and koto mirrors the age dynamic on screen between Fern and the elder woman. This adds grounding to the woman's words, while further shaping Fern's character as calm and collected (quiet strings with long note values) even while she has the right to be frustrated in their current situation. While this held-back musical scoring may seem a strange choice in the eyes of a western audience, Fern's character demonstrates a classic example of 'tatemae' (建前), a behaviour deeply ingrained in Japanese society.¹⁴ 'Tatemae' is a facade

¹⁴ Andrei-Teodor Radu, 'SOCIETY OF THE MASK. THE DISCONNECT BETWEEN HONNE AND TATEMAE IN JAPANESE CULTURE AND SOCIAL PHENOMENA', *Studia Universitatis Babes-Bolyai - Studia Europaea* 69, no. 2 (2024): 63–79.

one displays in order to maintain social harmony, a concealing one's true feelings to 'save face'. This concept is often exhibited in Japanese media, and characters in anime are no exception to this.¹⁵ The strings (representing Fern's character) mirror this display of 'tatemae', not outwardly expressing her frustration, but subtly hinting at it through the rising register (18:30), and lack of clear cadential resolutions, all while remaining texturally and harmonically unimposing and non-confrontational.

Toward the end of cue 5 (19:05), the instrumentation is reduced to solo piano. This subtly draws a connection between the feeling of defeat Fern encountered in cue 2 (05:07) with this moment. A series of unresolved chords here also mirror the unresolved defeating feeling which is growing in Fern- as she entertains the idea their search will never end.

At cue 7 (20:41), we are shown Frieren's memory of Himmel describing the 'Blue Moon Weed' (蒼月草), giving us more insight into why it is important to her. The change of instrumentation, rapid textural expansion, and clearer melodic material contributes to expressing Fern's shifting change of perspective into realising the importance of their search for this flower.

It was essential that I allowed space for the weight of Himmel's words 'Someday, I want to show it to you' ('いつか君に見せてあげたい') at 22:30. Here the strings reduce to a single note, which expands texturally, as the harmony follows the melodic rise to the climax at 22:41 where all the flowers are revealed.

The thematic material from cue 6 (17:05) is linked to this climax (23:35). While 17:05 depicts the characters being present in the moment and experiencing the slowness of life, this thematic link to the climactic scene from 23:35 further hints at the episode's overarching messages.

Throughout the score, the music guides us through Fern's changing view that magic needs only to be used as a survival tool, contrasting with Frieren's love for seemingly trivial spells. This highlights the series' theme, that joy and purpose often lie in the mundane. The episode's title 'It Didn't Have To Be Magic...' ('別に魔法じゃなくたって...') echoes this narrative through Frieren's teaching, showing that the value of time is measured by emotional investment, and not quantity nor activity.

¹⁵ Devi Haryanti Oktavia and Syihabuddin, 'Konsep Honne Tatemae Tokoh Utama dalam Anime Omoi Omoware Furi Furare', *AYUMI : Jurnal Budaya, Bahasa dan Sastra* 11, no. 1 (25 July 2024): 48–60, accessed doi:10.25139/ayumi.v11i1.7614.

Suzume no Tojimari: Opening the Door for the First Time

I used a similar orchestration as I did with Frieren, combining a blend of electronic, orchestral, and East Asian folk instruments (see Figure 8). Broadly, the electronic elements represent the unknown calamity, the orchestral scoring depicts the intricate natural beauty and scale of the monster, while the folk instruments sculpt the deep-rooted ancient and ageless quality of the monster and hidden world behind the door.

Unlike Frieren, this score makes strong use of percussion (synthesised hits, taiko drums, bass drums), as well as a number of extended string techniques to mirror the more dynamic nature and unpredictability of the scene. Some of these techniques include sul ponticello tremolo (01:39), layered harmonics (03:03), glissandi (03:21), and Bartok pizzicato (02:31). A few other interesting unconventionalities are the flutes at 03:29 which play aleatoric staccato around the pitches D and A synced to the hit points of the calamity hitting the ground. This along with the soft tremolo harp texture layering a 6-note chord (02:57) creates an unusual and unnerving soundscape.

The structure of the music consists of two builds and climaxes. The first ends at the hit point 02:50, and the second at the closure of the door (05:07). Through experimentation, I found that in the final quarter of the scene, energy levels became stagnant. By reducing the texture after hit point 02:50, this allowed more room to expand and grow in the second half of the scene. Following 02:50, Suzume's attention is drawn away from the calamity for the first time since the beginning of the scene. Because of this, reducing the music was appropriate, and invites the audience to become momentarily distracted from the calamity (just as Suzume is).

The soundtrack begins with a low, quiet drone, a sound representing Suzume's feeling of unease, shifting from A to G# when the scene cuts to Suzume's horrified face. I wanted to avoid the first cue becoming distracting from the events of the picture. As the unknown calamity seemingly comes out of nowhere and grows at an alarming rate, this is mirrored within the expanding texture and dynamics of the music. There is also a mirroring that as Suzume gets closer to the calamity, the texture becomes increasingly denser, until she is faced with it at 02:31.

One of the primary issues I faced was retaining momentum in the final climax to the door being closed (05:07). I wanted the music to take on a powerful air depicting Suzume's

resolve to help Souta close the door. To do this, I scored a 3-octave unison string melody harmonically supported by full choir and French horns. Meanwhile the marimba's repeating semiquaver phrase from 01:48 returns and is intensified with now harder mallets, and is texturally thickened by additional unison staccato flute, oboe and violin. These aid the increase of energy and surging momentum.

Ultimately, my goal in writing this score was to not only capture the scale of the calamity through sounds, but to also be able to shadow Suzume's emotional journey. I sought to create a soundscape that was able to mirror the scene's unsettling beauty.

Appendix:

Frieren OP:

Figure 1: Image of Frieren OP project (overleaf)

Playlist - Arrangement - Bass #2

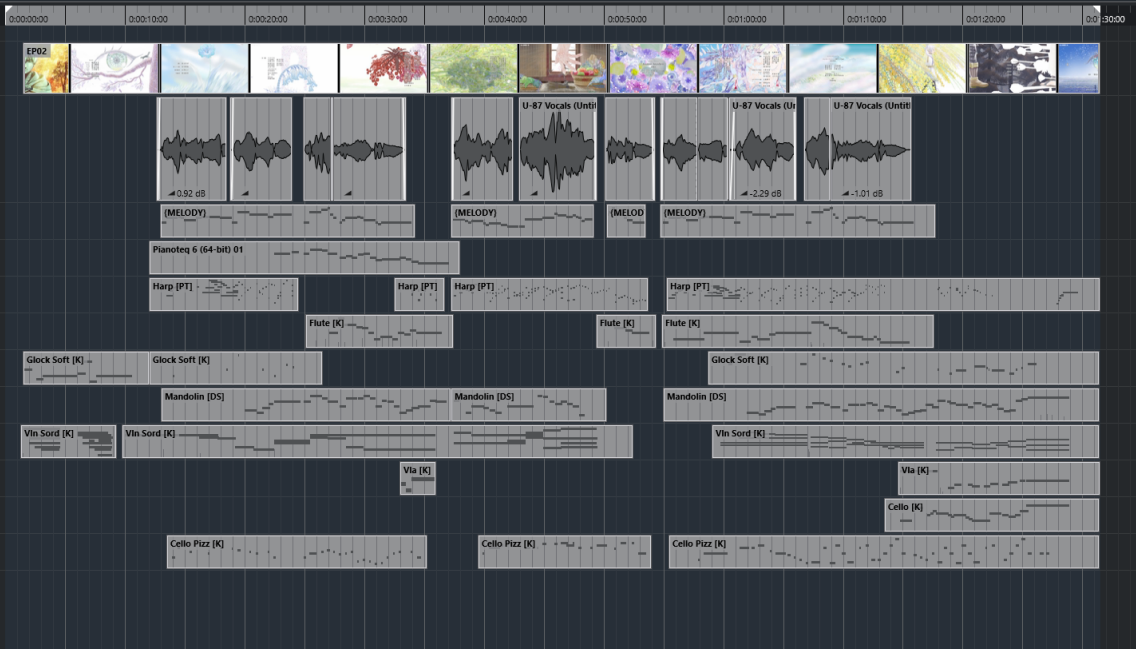
The screenshot displays a DAW interface with the following components:

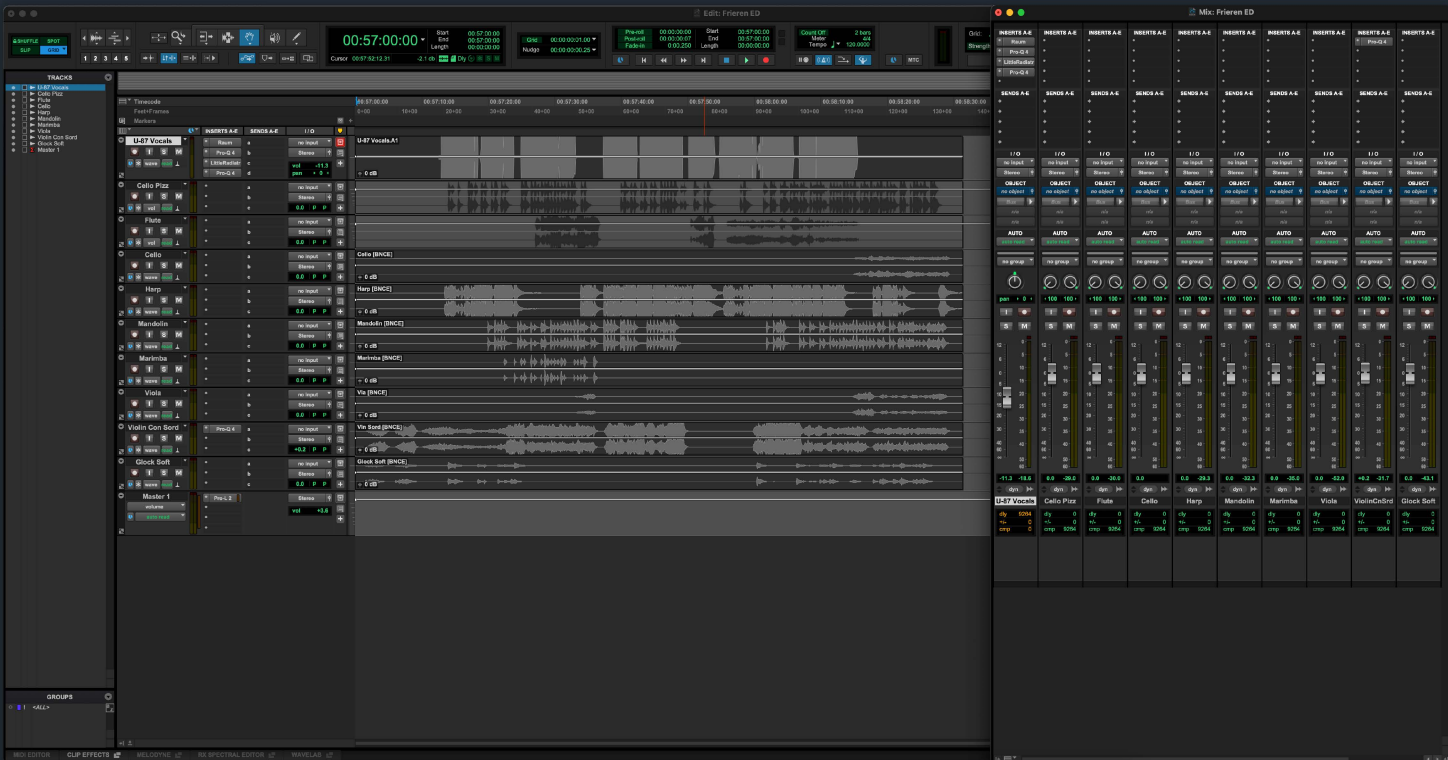
- Top Panel:** A piano roll view showing MIDI notes and audio waveforms across 45 measures. The arrangement includes tracks for Strings Stabs, Piano, Melody, Shakhachi, Brass, Bass, and Drums.
- Track List (Left):** A list of tracks including:
 - Strings Stabs
 - Strings Stabs #2
 - Piano short release #2
 - Piano Chords (Reference)
 - Piano short release
 - Melody (rep. x with voc)
 - Melody (repl. ith voc) #2
 - Piano Chord. (reference) #2
 - Brass
 - Bass
 - Bass #4
 - Bass #3
 - Celeste
 - Violins
 - Track 11
 - Bass #2
 - + Video
 - Shakhachi
 - Shakhachi #2
 - Shakhachi #3
 - Guitar strums
 - Guitar strums #2
 - Bass static
 - Piano 2
 - + Strings Verse
 - Pattern 25
 - Pattern 26
 - Track 21
- Mixer (Bottom):** A series of faders and EQ controls for each track. The tracks are labeled: Master, Insert 1, Melod. voc, Kick loop 1, Snare, Kick loop 2, Verse Drums, perc. loop, perc. op #2, drum break, Stm. Stabs, Solo Violin, Violins, Solo Violin, Bass, Synth Bass, CS Brass, F. Trips, Celeste, Sax 2, Sax 2 #2, Trump. Swirl, Pro sh. rel, Guitar, Shakhachi, Trump. os #2, Rhodes, and U-87 VOK. Each track has a fader and a set of EQ controls (Pro-Q 3, FabFilter, etc.).
- Right Panel:** A section labeled 'Master - U-87 VOK' with a list of tracks and a 'U-87 VOK' button.

Figure 2: Frieren OP Lyrics and English Translation

Lyrics:	English translation (for reference):
静かな夜、月明かりが部屋を照らす 思い出のかけら、心に浮かぶ あの日、感じた幸せ、今も鮮やかに	On a silent night, pools of moonlight spill into the room Fragments of memories rise softly through my heart The happiness I felt that day is still vivid, even now
時の流れは残酷で、すべてを奪ってしまう だけど、心の奥底に、あなたは生きている	The flow of time is cruel, time steals everything Yet deep within my soul, you live on
静かな夜、月明かりが部屋を照らす 思い出のかけら、心に浮かぶ あの日、感じた幸せ、今も鮮やかに	On a silent night, pools of moonlight spill into the room Fragments of memories rise softly through my heart The happiness I felt that day is still vivid, even now

Frieren ED:**Figure 3:** Images of Frieren ED project (overleaf)





永遠の旅人

(Eien no Tabibito / Eternal Traveler)

Brinsley Morrison
モリソン・プリンスリー

$\text{♩} = 120$

to - oi ta-bi - ji no ha - te hi - roi a - tsu - me - ta ka-ke - ta ka-ke-

11
-ra - ta - chi ya - sa - shii i - ro wo no - ko - shi - te

17
ka - ze ga ha - ko - bu wa - su - re - nai mo - no - ga - ta -

23
-ri ha - na no yo - u ni to - ki wo sa - ka - se - te

30
yo - zo - ra no ka - na - ta hi - ka - ri no i - to

38
mi - ra - i e tsu - zu - ku ya - sa - shii i - ro wo no - ko - shi - te

Figure 5: Frieren ED Lyrics and English Translation

Lyrics:	English translation (for reference):
遠い旅路の果て 拾い集めた 欠けた欠片たち 優しい色を残して	The end of a long journey I've picked up the pieces The missing pieces Leaving behind gentle colours
風が運ぶ 忘れない物語 花のように 時を咲かせて	Carried by the wind Stories I will never forget Like a flower Letting time bloom
夜空の彼方 光の糸 未来へ続く 優しい色を残して	Beyond the night sky Threads of light Continuing into the future Leaving behind gentle colours

Figure 6: Image of Frieren soundtrack project (overleaf)

Figure 7: Images of Suzume project and 5.1 mixer

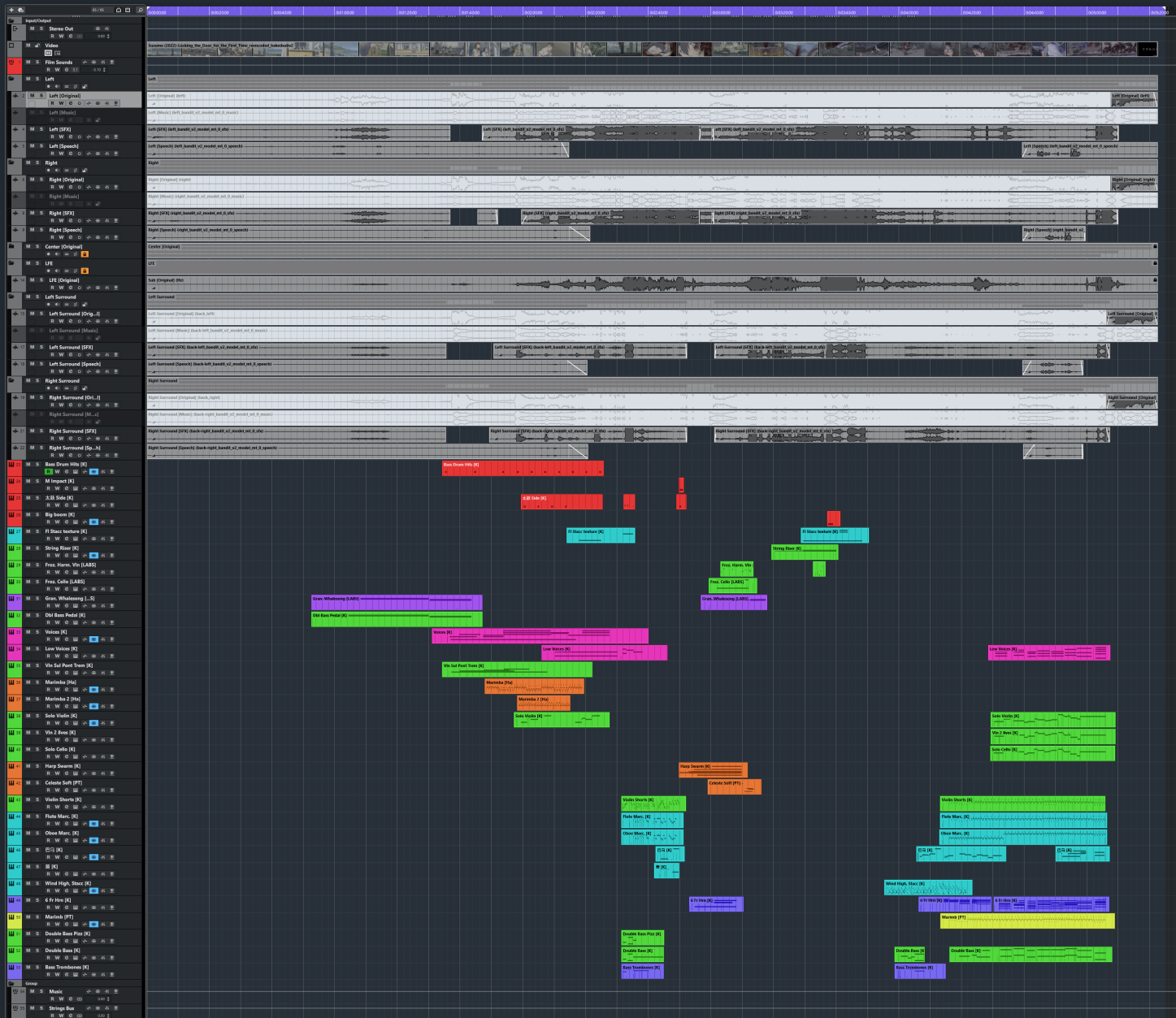




Figure 8: Application of FFmpeg:**Frieren:**

Extract audio as an interleaved stereo wav from the BlueRay disk:

```
ffmpeg -i ./BDMV/STREAM/00000.m2ts -map 0:1 -acodec pcm_s24le
output.wav
```

Convert video from BlueRay to usable & uncompressed MKV format:

```
ffmpeg -i ./BDMV/STREAM/00000.m2ts -map 0:v -c:v copy -map 0:a -c:a
copy -map 0:s? -c:s copy output.mkv
```

Combine the original video with my own audio after composition:

```
ffmpeg -i original.mkv -map 0:v -map 0:s? -map 1:a -c:v copy
-c:a flac -c:s copy -shortest output.mkv
```

Suzume:

Extract the 5.1 audio track from the BlueRay disk to 6 uncompressed mono wav files:

```
ffmpeg -i ./BDMV/STREAM/00000.m2ts -map 0:a:1 -filter_complex
"channelsplit=channel_layout=5.1[FL][FR][FC][LFE][BL][BR]" -map
"[FL]" -acodec pcm_s24le FL.wav -map "[FR]" -acodec pcm_s24le
FR.wav -map "[FC]" -acodec pcm_s24le FC.wav -map "[LFE]" -
acodec pcm_s24le LFE.wav -map "[BL]" -acodec pcm_s24le BL.wav -
map "[BR]" -acodec pcm_s24le BR.wav
```

Convert the video from BlueRay to usable & uncompressed MKV format:

```
ffmpeg -i ./BDMV/STREAM/00000.m2ts -map 0:v -c:v copy -map 0:a
-c:a copy -map 0:s? -c:s copy output.mkv
```

Combine the original video with my own audio after composition:

```
ffmpeg -i "Original film.mkv" -i "My audio.wav" -map 0:v:0 -map
1:a:0 -map 0:s:0 -c:v libx264 -crf 18 -preset slower -c:a aac -b:a
384k -metadata:s:a:0 title="5.1 Surround (or) Stereo" -c:s mov_text
-metadata:s:s:0 language=eng -to "323.031042" "Suzume 5.1 (or)
Stereo.mp4"
```

Naming scheme for samplers within Cubase Projects:

[K] = Native Instruments: Kontakt 7,

[HA] = Steinberg: HALion,

[LABS] = Spitfire Audio: LABS,

[DS] = decent | samples: DecentSampler,

[PT] = Modartt: Pianoteq 6.

Kontakt Libraries used:

Cinematic Studio Series:

Cinematic Studio Brass,
Cinematic Studio Woodwinds,
Cinematic Studio Strings,

Splash Sound:

Epic Percussion 2,

Performance Samples:

Fluid Shorts,
Oceania,
Pacific Solo Cello Legato,
Pacific Ensemble Strings,
Pacific Percussion,
Solo Violin Legato,

Strezov Sampling:

Choir Essentials,
Percussion Essentials X3M,
JADE Ethnic Orchestra,

Project SAM:

Symphobia 4 Pandora,

8Dio:

Fire trumpet,

Channel Robot:

The Modernist Glockenspiel,

Native Instruments:

Session Guitarist Electric Mint,

Spitfire Audio:

Frank Ricotti PP006 Glockenspiel,
London Contemporary Orchestra Strings,
Harp Swarm,

Fracture Sounds:

Moonlight Celeste,

Sonica Instruments:

KOTO 17,

Splice Originals:

Koto with Sumie Kaneko.

Resource List:

Video Sources (YouTube)

Anime Opening Song Forms Are Predictable, 2020. Accessed 9 April 2025

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UudxSY9rx0I>. Chihara, Minori. *Michishirube (Short Size)*,

2018. Accessed 2 March 2025 <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FiQ1nAurKal>.

ChouCho. *Yasashisa No Riyu*, 2012. Accessed 2 March 2025

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E22Fj5WCv2U>.

Hikasa, Yoko. *Utsukushiki Zankoku*, 2014. Accessed 2 March 2025

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BbTR1i2UrqM>.

LiSA. *Crossing Field*, 2013. Accessed 2 March 2025

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F9GXgPHeKfA>.

GitHub Repositories & Software

‘Facebookresearch/Demucs’. *Python*. 2019. Reprint, Meta Research, 20 February 2025. Accessed 20 February 2025 <https://github.com/facebookresearch/demucs>.

‘FFmpeg/FFmpeg’. C. 2011. Reprint, FFmpeg, 20 February 2025. Accessed 20 February 2025

<https://github.com/FFmpeg/FFmpeg>.

‘Kuielab/Mdx-Net’. *Python*. 2021. Reprint, IELab@ Korea University, 18 February 2025. Accessed 20 February 2025 <https://github.com/kuielab/mdx-net>.

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Dataset & Model Weights

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